IT SERVICE MANAGEMENT AND OPERATIONAL INCIDENT POLICY

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NOTE: Boundary with POL-012 (Incident Response Policy): this Policy governs operational incidents — unplanned disruptions caused by hardware failure, software faults, infrastructure issues, human configuration error, or environmental factors — where there is no evidence of malicious intent or security compromise. If at any point during an operational incident investigation evidence of malicious activity, unauthorised access, or data integrity compromise emerges, the Incident Commander must immediately notify Information Security and transition the event to the POL-012 security incident process. Both processes may run in parallel where warranted.

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description
0.1	[DATE]	[Author]	Initial draft
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1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the requirements for managing operational IT incidents — unplanned interruptions to, or reductions in the quality of, [Company Name]'s IT services that are not caused by malicious activity or security compromise. It defines how incidents are detected, classified, escalated, resolved, and followed through to permanent fix.

The need for this Policy is distinct from the security-focused POL-012 (Incident Response Policy). Operational incidents — a server crash, a database corruption, an application fault, a power failure affecting a data centre — follow different escalation paths, involve different teams, and create different obligations than security incidents. Conflating the two creates confusion about who leads, what the timelines are, and what regulatory requirements apply.

For GxP systems, operational incidents carry regulatory weight that purely operational ITSM frameworks typically fail to address. An unexpected outage of a LIMS, MES, or clinical data management system is not just a service desk ticket — it must be recorded in the Validation Master File, assessed for impact on the system's validated state, and signed off by Compliance / QA before the system returns to regulated use. This Policy makes those obligations explicit and integral to the incident process, not an afterthought.

> **GxP:** A regulatory inspector asking 'what is your procedure when the LIMS goes down unexpectedly?' expects to see: a documented incident process, evidence of Compliance / QA involvement, a record of the downtime period in the VMF, confirmation that no uncontrolled changes occurred during recovery, and sign-off before GxP activities resumed. This Policy provides that process.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to all unplanned IT service disruptions affecting [Company Name] systems classified under POL-005, regardless of hosting model (on-premises, cloud, SaaS). It covers:

- Unplanned system or application outages — complete loss of service availability
- Service degradation — partial loss of functionality or significant performance degradation affecting users' ability to carry out business activities
- Data access failures — inability to read, write, or retrieve data where the cause is infrastructure or application failure rather than access control
- Infrastructure failures — network, storage, compute, power, or environmental failures affecting system availability
- Third-party service failures — SaaS, cloud platform, or vendor-hosted system outages affecting [Company Name] operations

This Policy does not apply to: planned maintenance windows (governed by POL-007); security incidents involving malicious activity (governed by POL-012); or disaster-scale events requiring full BC/DR activation (governed by POL-011). The escalation criteria to each of those processes are defined in this Policy.

3. Operational Incident Severity Classification

Operational incident severity is assessed on business impact — the effect on [Company Name]'s ability to operate, meet regulatory obligations, and serve its functions. The system's POL-005 criticality tier is the primary input; the regulatory flags (GxP, SOX) elevate severity when the impact touches those domains.

Severity	Criteria	Acknowledgement SLA	Resolution Target	Escalation
P1 — Critical	Complete outage of a Tier 1 system OR outage of a Tier 2 system during financial close or regulatory submission period OR GxP system outage affecting active batch processing, clinical trial data capture, or product release OR outage affecting ≥ 50% of users organisation-wide OR data loss or corruption affecting Tier 1 or Tier 2 systems	15 minutes (24/7)	4 hours (or RTO from POL-011 if shorter)	CIO within 15 min. CISO if potential security component. Compliance / QA within 30 min if GxP. CFO if SOX system during financial close.
P2 — High	Partial outage or significant degradation of a Tier 1 system OR complete outage of a Tier 2 system (outside financial close) OR GxP system degradation affecting data entry or reporting (but not active regulated release activities) OR outage affecting a defined business-critical function across a department	30 minutes (business hours); 1 hour (out of hours)	8 hours	CIO within 1 hour. Compliance / QA within 1 hour if GxP.
P3 — Medium	Complete outage of a Tier 3 system OR degradation of a Tier 2 system with acceptable workaround available OR single-user or small-group impact on Tier 1/2 system	2 hours (business hours)	Next business day	IT Operations Manager. System Owner notified.

Severity	Criteria	Acknowledgement SLA	Resolution Target	Escalation
P4 — Low	Tier 4 system outage OR minor degradation with workaround OR cosmetic or non-functional defect not affecting business operations	1 business day	5 business days (or scheduled maintenance)	Service Desk. Logged and queued.

NOTE: Severity must be assessed at the time of the incident based on known impact. It may be escalated — but not downgraded — during the active response period. If initial classification was P3 and investigation reveals a Tier 1 system is affected or data loss has occurred, severity is immediately re-classified to P1 and escalation timelines restart from the re-classification point.

4. Operational Incident Lifecycle

4.1 Stage 1 — Detection and Logging

Incidents may be detected by monitoring systems (infrastructure alerts, application performance monitoring, synthetic transaction monitoring), by users reporting service disruption, by third-party providers, or during scheduled checks. All incidents — regardless of source — must be logged in the ITSM platform within the acknowledgement SLA.

Step 01	**Log the Incident** Create a ticket in the ITSM platform recording: date and time detected; system(s) affected with POL-005 tier and regulatory flags; initial description of the disruption; reporter identity; initial severity estimate; and any actions already taken. Assign an Incident ID. The clock for all SLAs starts at the time of logging — not the time of resolution or confirmation.	Responsible **Service Desk / IT Operations**

4.2 Stage 2 — Classification and Escalation

Step 02	**Classify Severity and Escalate** IT Operations reviews the logged incident and confirms or adjusts the severity classification per Section 3. For P1 and P2 incidents: the Incident Manager is assigned and all escalations per Section 3 are initiated within the SLA. For GxP-flagged systems: Compliance / QA is notified immediately regardless of severity — a P3 or P4 incident on a GxP system still requires a VMF record. For P1 incidents: declare a Major Incident per Section 5. For incidents with any indication of security compromise: notify Information Security immediately and initiate parallel POL-012 process.	Responsible **IT Operations / Incident Manager**

4.3 Stage 3 — Investigation and Diagnosis

Step 03	**Diagnose the Root Cause** Identify the proximate cause of the disruption: infrastructure failure, application fault, configuration error, third-party service failure, or data corruption. Document findings in the ITSM ticket in real time. For data corruption incidents: before any recovery actions, confirm whether the corruption affects records on GxP or SOX-scoped systems — if so, involve Compliance / QA and (for SOX) Finance before data recovery begins, to assess regulatory impact. If root cause investigation reveals evidence of deliberate action, unauthorised access, or anomalous behaviour inconsistent with the technical failure: suspend the operational incident process, preserve the current system state, and transfer to POL-012 immediately.	Responsible **IT Operations / Technical Specialist**

4.4 Stage 4 — Resolution

Step 04	**Restore Service** Implement the fix, workaround, or recovery action necessary to restore service. All changes to production systems implemented during incident resolution — including emergency fixes — are emergency changes under POL-007 and must be documented with a change record referencing the Incident ID. There is no 'emergency' exception to this requirement. For Tier 1 and GxP systems: do not restore service using backup data or revert configurations without confirming the target restore point is known-good and within the validation baseline for GxP systems.	Responsible **IT Operations / Technical Specialist**

IMPORTANT: For GxP systems: restoration from backup constitutes a qualification event. The restored system must be assessed against the validation baseline. If the restore point pre-dates the most recent validation evidence, or if the restoration process itself involved any configuration changes, Compliance / QA must conduct a post-recovery assessment before the system is returned to GxP use. This is not optional — it is required by EU Annex 11 §13.

4.5 Stage 5 — Confirmation and Closure

Step 05	**Confirm Resolution** Service restoration is confirmed with the affected user(s) or System Owner before the incident is closed. Closure requires: (1) affected service confirmed as operational; (2) for GxP systems — Compliance / QA written confirmation that the system is in its validated state and GxP activities may resume; (3) for SOX systems — Finance and/or Internal Audit confirmation that ITGC audit trail is intact if data loss or corruption was involved; (4) Incident record updated with actual resolution time and resolution description. Incidents must not be closed without affected party confirmation. Auto-closure without confirmation is prohibited for P1, P2, and all incidents involving GxP or SOX-scoped systems.	Responsible **Incident Manager / System Owner / Compliance / QA (GxP)**

4.6 Stage 6 — Post-Incident Review and Problem Management

Incident response closes when the service is restored. Problem management begins — finding the permanent fix so the incident does not recur. These are separate activities with separate owners.

Activity	Trigger	Timeline	Responsible
Post-Incident Review (PIR)	Every P1 incident. Every P2 incident on a GxP or SOX-scoped system. Any incident where resolution exceeded the SLA target.	P1: within 3 business days of closure. P2 (GxP/SOX): within 5 business days.	Incident Manager + System Owner + Compliance / QA (GxP)

Activity	Trigger	Timeline	Responsible
PIR documentation	All PIRs	PIR report completed within the timeframe above.	Incident Manager
Problem Record creation	Any P1. Any recurring P2/P3 (same system, same root cause, ≥ 2 occurrences in 90 days).	Within 3 business days of PIR completion.	IT Operations
Root Cause Analysis (RCA)	Every Problem Record	Within 10 business days of Problem Record creation.	Technical Specialist + System Owner
Change Request	Where RCA identifies a permanent fix requiring a system change	Via POL-007 — change record references both the Incident ID and Problem Record ID.	System Owner
VMF Problem Record (GxP systems only)	Every P1 and P2 on a GxP system; every incident where Compliance / QA confirmed a validated state impact	PIR report and RCA added to VMF within 10 business days of completion.	Compliance / QA
ITSM trend review	Recurring incidents on Tier 1/2 systems	Quarterly — presented to ISSG if trending upward.	IT Operations / CIO

5. Major Incident Process (P1)

A Major Incident is any P1 operational incident. It activates an elevated response structure — the Major Incident Team (MIT) — with defined command, communication, and escalation requirements distinct from the standard ITSM process.

5.1 Major Incident Team (MIT)

Role	Responsibility	Activation
Major Incident Manager (MIM) (IT Operations)	Commands the Major Incident response. Maintains the Incident Bridge (call or war room). Updates stakeholders at defined intervals. Makes escalation and workaround decisions. Owns all stakeholder communications during the incident.	All P1 incidents
Technical Lead (IT Operations / relevant team)	Leads technical diagnosis and resolution. Provides regular diagnosis updates to MIM. Implements resolution actions via POL-007 emergency change process.	All P1 incidents
CIO	Receives initial notification within 15 minutes. Authorises major decisions (BC/DR activation, customer/regulator communication, major technical action). Escalates to CEO and Board if required.	All P1 incidents
Compliance / QA	Activated for all P1 incidents on GxP systems. Confirms impact on validation status. Signs off validated state confirmation before GxP restart. Assesses regulatory notification obligation for GxP outages affecting product quality or trial integrity.	P1 on any GxP-flagged system
Finance / Controller	Activated for P1 incidents on SOX-scoped systems during financial close. Assesses impact on financial processing integrity and audit trail.	P1 on SOX-scoped system during financial close
CISO	Activated if any security component is identified or suspected during the incident.	P1 with suspected security component — transitions to joint POL-012/POL-015 response
Communications	Activated if P1 incident affects external-facing services or triggers customer SLA obligations.	P1 with external impact

5.2 Communication Cadence During Major Incidents

Audience	Initial Notification	Update Frequency	Responsible
CIO	Within 15 minutes of P1 declaration	Every 30 minutes until resolved	MIM
System Owner	Within 30 minutes	Every 60 minutes	MIM
Compliance / QA (GxP systems)	Within 30 minutes	As material status changes	MIM
Affected business users	Within 1 hour	Every 2 hours	MIM / Communications
CISO	Immediately if security component identified	Per POL-012 schedule if transitioned	MIM
Regulator / customers (if SLA breach)	Per contractual obligation — assessed by CIO	Per contract	CIO / Communications / Legal

5.3 BC/DR Escalation Threshold

A P1 Major Incident escalates to full BC/DR activation under POL-011 when any of the following criteria are met. The CIO, CISO, and MIM jointly make the activation decision:

- Projected resolution time will breach the system's RTO target (per POL-011 Section 3)
- Root cause cannot be resolved within the system's Maximum Tolerable Period of Disruption (MTPD)
- The incident affects multiple Tier 1 or Tier 2 systems simultaneously — indicating infrastructure-layer failure
- The primary site is unavailable or inaccessible

Once BC/DR is activated: the CIO assumes overall recovery command; the Major Incident Manager continues to coordinate technical resolution; Compliance / QA maintains the GxP regulatory thread. The POL-011 BCP/DRP takes precedence over this Policy's resolution process from the point of activation.

6. GxP System Operational Incidents — Additional Requirements

For every incident affecting a GxP-flagged system — regardless of severity — the following requirements apply in addition to the standard incident process. These requirements exist because EU Annex 11 and 21 CFR Part 11 require that GxP systems operate in a state of continuous control, and any unplanned event must be assessed for impact on that control.

Requirement	Obligation	Evidence Required
Compliance / QA notification	Compliance / QA must be notified of every incident on a GxP system, regardless of severity. P1/P2: within the escalation SLA in Section 3. P3/P4: within 1 business day. Notification must include: system affected, nature of disruption, duration, and any actions taken.	Notification record in ITSM ticket. Email or ITSM notification to Compliance / QA with timestamp.
Incident period documentation	The period of system unavailability or degradation must be documented. If the GxP system generates a system audit trail: the incident period must be documented in or alongside the audit trail (e.g., a system annotation or offline record) to explain the gap. An unexplained gap in audit trail records is an ALCOA+ completeness failure.	ITSM incident record with start/end timestamps. Audit trail annotation or supplementary record covering the incident period.
Validation status assessment	Before the system is returned to GxP use: Compliance / QA must assess whether the incident or recovery actions have affected the validated state of the system. Assessment must consider: were any configuration changes made during recovery? Was the system restored from backup, and if so, from which point? Was the recovery process itself within the scope of the validated configuration?	Written assessment from Compliance / QA: either confirming no impact on validated state, or documenting the specific impact and the additional qualification steps required before GxP restart.
Validated state confirmation sign-off	No GxP system may resume regulated activities — batch record processing, clinical data entry, regulatory submission, product release activities — after	Written sign-off from Compliance / QA in ITSM ticket and/or VMF. Timestamp of GxP restart must be after sign-off timestamp.

Requirement	Obligation	Evidence Required
	an operational incident until Compliance / QA has provided written confirmation that the system is in its validated state.	
VMF incident record	Every P1 and P2 incident on a GxP system, and every incident where Compliance / QA identified a validated state impact, must be recorded in the Validation Master File. The VMF entry includes: the incident record reference, the nature and duration of the disruption, the recovery actions taken, and the validation status assessment outcome.	VMF entry cross-referenced to ITSM Incident ID. Signed by System Owner and Compliance / QA.
GxP regulatory notification assessment	Compliance / QA must assess whether the incident requires regulatory notification — particularly if the disruption affected product quality, batch record completeness, or clinical trial data integrity. Assessment must be documented even where the conclusion is that notification is not required.	Compliance / QA assessment document. If notification required: Legal involvement per POL-012 Section 7.3.
CAPA where impact confirmed	Where Compliance / QA confirms a validated state impact: a Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA) must be initiated. The CAPA links to the ITSM Problem Record and to the POL-007 change request for the permanent fix.	CAPA reference in VMF. POL-007 change record referencing CAPA.

7. SOX In-Scope System Operational Incidents — Additional Requirements

Operational incidents affecting SOX-scoped systems must be assessed for impact on ITGC controls and financial data integrity:

- Finance and Internal Audit must be notified of any P1 or P2 incident on a SOX-scoped system within the escalation SLA defined in Section 3
- If the incident involves data loss or corruption: Finance must confirm that no financial transaction records have been lost or altered before the system is returned to financial

processing. If confirmation cannot be given: the impacted transactions must be identified and reconciled before the system resumes

- If the incident results in ITGC audit evidence (access logs, change records, audit trail records) being lost or corrupted: this constitutes a potential control deficiency and must be reported to the CFO and external auditors — even if the underlying service was restored fully
- SOX-scoped system incidents and their resolution are ITGC evidence — ITSM records for P1 and P2 incidents on SOX systems must be retained for 7 years per POL-002
- Planned maintenance on SOX-scoped systems during financial close periods is prohibited per POL-007; emergency fixes during this period require CFO awareness

8. Problem Management

Problem management is the process of identifying and permanently eliminating the root cause of incidents. An incident is closed when the service is restored. A problem is closed only when the underlying cause has been permanently fixed or formally accepted as a residual risk. These are different activities, often with different timescales.

Problem Management Step	Description	Responsible
Problem identification	A Problem Record is created for: every P1 incident; every P2/P3 incident on a GxP or SOX-scoped system; any incident recurring ≥ 2 times in 90 days on the same system with the same root cause. Problem Records are linked to the originating Incident ID(s).	IT Operations
Root Cause Analysis (RCA)	A structured root cause analysis is conducted. Acceptable methodologies include '5 Whys', Fishbone/Ishikawa, or Fault Tree Analysis. The RCA must identify the root cause (not just the proximate trigger) and must distinguish between: a technical defect requiring a fix, a process or configuration weakness requiring a change, or an environmental factor requiring a procedural control.	Technical Specialist + System Owner
Known Error Record	Where a root cause has been identified but the permanent fix has not yet been implemented: a Known Error Record is created documenting the workaround available and the expected fix timeline. Known Errors on Tier 1 and GxP systems are reviewed at ISSG quarterly.	IT Operations
Change Request	The permanent fix is implemented via a POL-007 Normal or Standard change	System Owner via POL-007

Problem Management Step	Description	Responsible
	request. The change record references both the Incident ID(s) and the Problem Record ID. For GxP systems: the change requires a validation impact assessment per POL-006/POL-007.	
Problem closure	A Problem Record is closed when: (a) the permanent fix has been implemented and confirmed effective via monitoring for ≥ 30 days without recurrence; or (b) the risk has been formally accepted under POL-010 with documented rationale. GxP Problem Records are not closed until Compliance / QA confirms the CAPA is complete and the VMF is updated.	IT Operations + Compliance / QA (GxP)

9. Relationship to Other Policies — Decision Points

The table below defines the specific decision points at which this Policy hands off to, or operates in parallel with, other IMF policies. These are not optional escalation paths — they are mandatory triggers.

Trigger Condition	Action Required	Governing Policy
Any indication of malicious activity, unauthorised access, or deliberate data manipulation during an operational incident investigation	Suspend operational incident process. Preserve system state. Notify Information Security immediately. Transfer to security incident process. Both processes may run in parallel where operational recovery and security investigation are separable.	POL-012 — Incident Response Policy
P1 incident where projected resolution will breach the system's RTO, or where MTPD is at risk	Initiate BC/DR activation decision with CIO, CISO, and MIM jointly. If activated: POL-011 BCP/DRP takes command of recovery.	POL-011 — Business Continuity Policy
Any change to a production system implemented during incident resolution (fix, workaround, configuration revert, patch)	Document as emergency change in POL-007 ITSM record. For GxP systems: validation impact assessment required. Incident ID referenced in change record.	POL-007 — Change Management Policy
Any incident on a GxP-flagged system — regardless of severity	Notify Compliance / QA within escalation SLA (P1/P2) or within 1 business day (P3/P4). Complete	POL-006, POL-003, SOP-003 — Validation and Data Integrity

Trigger Condition	Action Required	Governing Policy
	all GxP requirements in Section 6. No GxP restart without Compliance / QA sign-off.	
Data loss or corruption affecting personal data (any tier)	Notify DPO immediately. DPO assesses GDPR/HIPAA notification obligation. GDPR 72-hour clock runs from point of awareness — do not wait for confirmation.	POL-012, SOP-004 — Incident Response and Privacy Process
Incident results in unplanned downtime creating POL-010 risk register entry (Operational Availability risk)	Incident Manager notifies Information Security for risk assessment update within 30 days of P1 closure. Recurring P2 incidents on same system also trigger risk review.	POL-010 — Information Security Risk Policy
P1 or P2 on SOX-scoped system with data loss, corruption, or ITGC evidence impact	Notify CFO and Internal Audit. If external auditors engaged: notify per audit agreement. Retain all ITSM records for 7 years.	POL-002 — Data Retention (for SOX evidence)

10. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
CIO	Policy owner. Receives all P1 notifications. Authorises BC/DR activation decisions. Approves major technical decisions during Major Incidents. Reviews quarterly ITSM trend data. Approves Known Error acceptance for Tier 1 systems.
IT Operations / Major Incident Manager	Manages day-to-day incident response. Declares Major Incidents. Leads MIT for P1 incidents. Maintains ITSM platform. Produces PIR reports. Manages Problem Records and Known Error Register.
Data Custodian (IT)	Executes technical investigation and resolution. Implements emergency changes per POL-007. Manages backup and recovery infrastructure. Confirms service restoration.
System Owner	Confirms service restoration from a business perspective. Provides business impact input during incidents. Owns the Problem Record for their system. Authorises risk acceptance for Known Errors on their system.
Compliance / QA	Receives all GxP system incident notifications. Conducts validation status assessments. Signs off GxP restart. Maintains VMF incident and CAPA records. Assesses GxP regulatory notification obligation.
CISO	Activated if security component identified. Coordinates parallel POL-012 process if required. Advises on security-related containment actions during operational incidents.
DPO	Activated for incidents involving personal data loss or corruption. Manages GDPR/HIPAA notification assessment. Activated per POL-012/SOP-004 for personal data breach component.
Finance / Controller	Activated for P1 on SOX-scoped systems during financial close. Confirms financial data integrity before SOX system restart. Notified of ITGC evidence loss.
All IT staff	Report detected incidents immediately. Document all actions taken in the ITSM ticket in real time. Implement fixes only via approved emergency change process (POL-007).

11. Related Documents

Document ID	Title	Relationship
IMF-001	Information Management Framework	Parent framework
POL-005	System Classification Policy	Criticality tier and regulatory flags are primary

Document ID	Title	Relationship
		inputs to incident severity classification and escalation requirements
POL-006	Computer System Validation and Qualification Policy	GxP system recovery from operational incident is a qualification event; VMF must document incidents and restoration; post-recovery assessment required per Annex 11 §13
POL-003	Data Integrity Policy	Audit trail continuity during operational incidents is an ALCOA+ Completeness obligation; incident period must be documented to explain any audit trail gap
POL-007	Change Management Policy	All changes implemented during incident resolution are emergency changes under POL-007; root cause fixes implemented via Normal or Standard change; POL-007 change freeze periods affect planned maintenance timing
POL-010	Information Security Risk Policy	P1 incidents and recurring P2 incidents on Tier 1/2 systems are Operational Availability risks to be reflected in the IS Risk Register; Known Errors on Tier 1 systems are open risks
POL-011	Business Continuity Policy	P1 incidents breaching RTO trigger BC/DR activation under POL-011; this Policy provides the pre-BC/DR incident response; Section 5.3 defines the activation threshold
POL-012	Incident Response Policy	Security incidents (malicious activity, unauthorised access) are governed by POL-012 not this Policy; any operational incident where security involvement is identified immediately transitions to POL-012; CISO is Incident Commander for security incidents; CIO is for operational
SOP-003	Data Integrity Process	GxP system incidents must be assessed using DIRA methodology; VMF incident records feed the DIRA Register under SOP-003
SOP-004	Privacy Process	Operational incidents involving personal data loss or corruption activate SOP-004 breach response in parallel; DPO manages GDPR/HIPAA notification
POL-014	Audit Trail and Monitoring Policy	Operational incidents on GxP systems create audit trail gaps that are ALCOA+ completeness issues — the incident period must be documented in or alongside the audit trail per POL-014; audit trail continuity monitoring alerts must be investigated under this Policy
EXC-001	Exception Management Policy and Register	Operational incident response exceptions (e.g., extended RTO before BC/DR) are subject to

Document ID	Title	Relationship
		EXC-001; exceptions affecting GxP system recovery validation require Compliance/QA involvement
RACI-001	Roles, Responsibilities and Authorities	Operational incident and service management accountability

12. Definitions

Term	Definition
CAPA (Corrective and Preventive Action)	A quality management tool used to identify and eliminate the root causes of non-conformances and prevent recurrence. For GxP systems: CAPA records are maintained in the quality management system and VMF.
Incident (operational)	An unplanned interruption to, or reduction in the quality of, an IT service that is not caused by malicious activity or security compromise.
Incident Bridge	A dedicated conference call or collaboration channel activated during Major Incidents to coordinate the MIT response in real time.
Known Error	A problem for which the root cause has been identified but the permanent fix has not yet been implemented. A workaround may be available.
Major Incident	A P1 operational incident activating the elevated MIT response structure defined in Section 5.
MTPD (Maximum Tolerable Period of Disruption)	The maximum time a business function can be unavailable before irreversible consequences occur. Defined per system in the BIA under POL-011.
Post-Incident Review (PIR)	A structured review of a resolved incident to assess the adequacy of the response, identify lessons learned, and initiate Problem Management.
Problem	The underlying root cause of one or more incidents. An incident is closed when service is restored; a problem is closed only when the root cause is permanently fixed.
RTO (Recovery Time Objective)	The maximum acceptable elapsed time between the onset of disruption and restoration of the service to an operational state. Defined per tier in POL-011.
VMF (Validation Master File)	The collection of documentation that records the validated state of a GxP system, including qualification records, change history, and incident/deviation records.

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